I've further categorized these functions according to their utility in rendering, transport safety, special interpolation (for handling strings in syntactic context), and (in one case only) fun factor. The functions for rendering and transport safety are not examined here. They can be found in Chapter 11, "Programming for the Internet" – where it makes more sense to explain those functions in their proper context. That leaves us with a handful of specialized oddities, which we'll look at briefly.

Special Interpolation

These functions are fairly limited in their utility. They are intended for escaping specific meta-characters when the source string is intended for interpolation into another string containing meta-characters. Historically they have been abused as sanitizing functions for creating database queries (looking at you, `addslashes()`); if you encounter them in legacy codebases, be *very* certain about their intended use.

addslashes(), stripslashes()

These functions will add (or remove) a backslash character in front of the ASCII characters ', ", \, and the null byte *0x00*. This can be useful when the string is intended for use in another context, but not, I repeat, *NOT* for use in writing something like a MySQL query (there are better and safer techniques for that, which we briefly looked at in the "Databases" section in Chapter 1, "Getting Started").

```
$str = "Some data for use 'elsewhere'\x00";
$str = addslashes($str);

print $str . PHP_EOL;
print stripslashes($str);

Output:
Some data for use \\'elsewhere\\'\\0
Some data for use 'elsewhere'
```

These functions are binary-safe and will work just fine on UTF-8 data (with an ASCII collision-avoidance mechanism). Other Unicode encodings will be utterly destroyed by the null-byte escaping.

addcslashes(), stripcslashes()